PLMN Concept Infographic – Fi

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MOBILE NETWORKS, DECODED

What is a PLMN?

A Public Land Mobile Network is the complete system a mobile operator uses to connect your phone—to calls, messages, data, and the wider world.

THE JOURNEY OF A CONNECTION



ONE SYSTEM, FOUR JOBS

01 **Identify**

Recognize your SIM and subscription

02 **Connect**

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THE JOURNEY OF A CONNECTION



Your phone

SIM identifies you

1



Radio access

Towers carry signal

2



Core network

Routes & authenticates

ONE SYSTEM, FOUR JOBS

01 **Identify**

Recognize your SIM and subscription

02 **Connect**

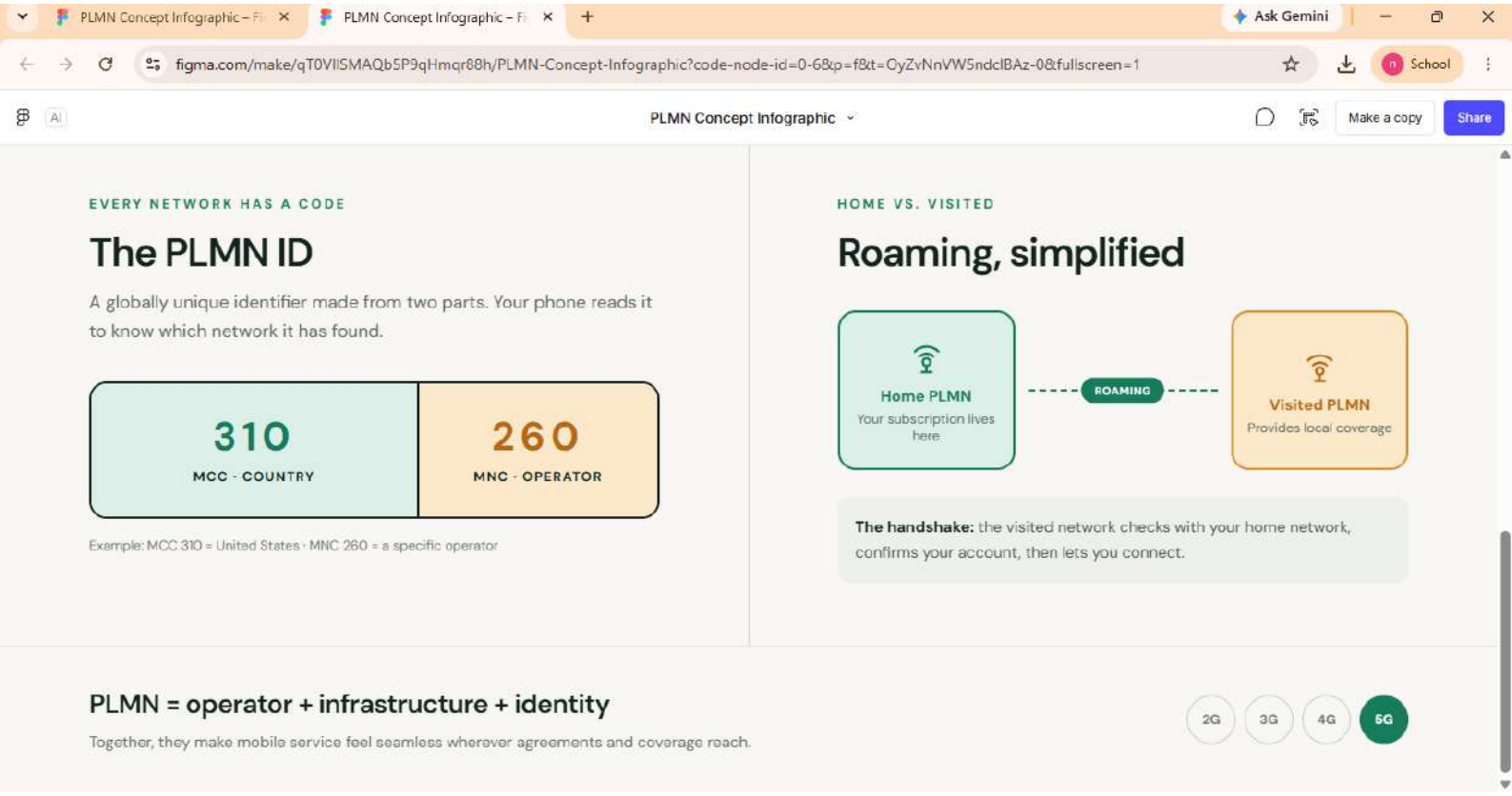
Link your device to a nearby cell

03 **Route**

Send voice, SMS, and data onward

04 **Secure**

Authenticate access and encrypt traffic


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EVERY NETWORK HAS A CODE
The PLMN ID
A globally unique identifier made from two parts. Your phone reads it to know which network it has found.
310
MCC · COUNTRY
260
MNC · OPERATOR
Example: MCC 310 = United States · MNC 260 = a specific operator
HOME VS. VISITED
Roaming, simplified
Home PLMN
Your subscription lives here
ROAMING
Visited PLMN
Provides local coverage
The handshake: the visited network checks with your home network, confirms your account, then lets you connect.
PLMN = operator + infrastructure + identity
Together, they make mobile service feel seamless wherever agreements and coverage reach.
2G
3G
4G
5G